

1904, February 21st

The following is a faithful transcription of a typed copy of the original letter by the servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

CAPUCHIN MONASTERY

661 FOURTH STR.

MILWAUKEE, WIS.

Milwaukee, Wis.
Feb. 21st, 1904

Mrs. Ella Traynor
(Spokane?), Washington

My Dear Sister;

Father was here on the 10th and all are well at home, thanks be to God! He said that you seemed to be lonesome out there, being so far from church etc. Well Dear Ella, I only pray you to content yourself for the present and pray and hope-even as you know poor dear Mother did, at the River-bank & at Trimbelle. You must know that there were trials in those places and indeed patience & resignation exercised. Now after so many years Father speaks of great consolation. It is really enough to draw a tear of admiration and gratitude for God's merciful providence, if one only considers the past (of our dear Parents) and now beholds their present circumstances and prospects. May their sky continue to brighten as their end approaches.

For my part dear Sister I congratulate you on your present trials much rather than if you were "prospering" in riches even within a block of the Most Blessed Sacrament. I think you and yours are safer, especially in the long run. If you only make your acts of contrition, etc. properly you need not be so uneasy about so frequent oral confession - and then your spiritual Communion. I pray you also to have our "Mass-prayers" at Trimbelle imitated, and Owney come to the same if possible-your neighbors, also even if they are not-Catholics, and do not neglect, in your rosaries to think at least sometimes of poor me. I received sub-deaconship Dec. 8th and will probably be ordained deacon-and priest before August. May the Holy Ghost direct my Superiors in their decisions in this regard & His holy Will in all things be done. I asked my Superior for material and permission to write to you and he gave me also this little picture for you.

With love to Br. Thomas (Traynor) and Owen and all & a caress for the Little Ones from your brother.

Fr. Solanus O.M. Cap.
Resignation +

P.S. Admonish Br. Owney not to neglect the most salutary--almsgiving for poor and orphans.

Original is in possession of:

Mrs. Charles D'Amico
1100 University St.
Seattle, Washington 98109